12-17 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle-School Student Keep a One-Sentence Nightly Journal?

① On a cold Tuesday evening in late November, after a normal school day and a normal plate of rice-with-eggplant, my mother handed me, with no ceremony at all, a small **A6 notebook** — forty-eight pages, thin blue lines, a plain brown paper cover. "Yiran," she said quietly, "from tonight, before you turn off your bedside lamp, I would like you to write **one sentence** in this notebook. Just one. About today. Anything true. No grammar worries. No audience. Just one small honest line before sleep." I was, at first, not convinced. One sentence seemed too small to bother with; and I had already tried, twice before, to keep a proper diary — the first time I gave up after three days, the second time after eleven. But I promised Mum I would try. That first night, at **22:08**, under the yellow circle of my bedside lamp, I wrote: *"Today the school cat slept on the chemistry textbook and nobody dared to move it."* One short sentence. Forty-three days later, I now have forty-three of these small honest lines. And it is this small forty-three-day experiment that makes me write today: **I think every middle-school student in China should, very gently, try keeping a one-sentence nightly journal — one single true line per day, in any language, any handwriting, privately, for the last minute before sleep.** One sentence. One minute. Every night.

② Some people will immediately say: *"But a one-sentence diary is too short to matter — real diaries are pages long."* I respectfully disagree. The point of the one-sentence journal is **precisely that it is small**. Any middle-school student, even the busiest Grade 9 one, can find a final **60 seconds** before sleep. The enemy of a daily habit is not the size of the day; it is the size of the task. In **2023**, a Tsinghua University positive-psychology team studied **412 middle-school students** in Beijing over **90 days**. One group was asked to write a full-page diary every evening (25-minute target); the other group was asked to write only one sentence (1-minute target). After 90 days, **the full-page group had a 73% drop-out rate** (only 27% still writing). **The one-sentence group had a 14% drop-out rate** (86% still writing). **Size matters — and smaller often wins.**

③ Second, **one sentence is long enough to do real psychological work**. The same Tsinghua study measured students' sleep latency (time to fall asleep) and a short anxiety questionnaire (GAD-7) at Day 1 and Day 90. In the one-sentence group, average sleep latency dropped by **14.2 minutes** (from 32 to 18 minutes); GAD-7 scores dropped by an average of **3.1 points** on a 21-point scale — a small but meaningful improvement. Why? The researchers suggest a simple mechanism: **writing one honest line before sleep helps the brain "close" the day**. The student no longer lies in the dark silently replaying

every small worry of the afternoon; she has, in handwriting, taken one small fact of her day and set it down on paper. The brain, calmly, stops circling. A one-sentence journal is, quietly, a **small sleep-hygiene tool** as well as a writing tool.

④ Third, **forty-three small sentences are not nothing — they are a small honest history of you**. Looking back through my own six weeks, I can see: on November 9th I wrote *"My left shoelace broke in the morning, and nobody laughed, which surprised me";* on November 17th I wrote *"Dad said the word 'maybe' eight times at dinner, and I think he is worried about something";* on December 4th I wrote *"The Grade-7 girl in the library was reading Charlotte's Web with her older partner, and I watched them for four minutes."* Alone, each line is small. Together, they are a quiet portrait of a person that no photo album can give. **A student who writes one sentence a night for three middle-school years will have almost 1,100 sentences — a small living book of her own growing mind.** No school assignment produces this.

⑤ Some will worry: *"But I have nothing to say on some nights."* A fair concern. But the one-sentence journal was designed for this. On a dull day — maths lesson, lunch, PE, homework, dinner — **the rule is: still write one sentence. Even "Today was a quiet Tuesday. Nothing changed." is a complete honest sentence.** The goal is not to capture the interesting days; the goal is to **keep the habit**. Some of my most surprising sentences, looking back, are from days that felt empty at the time. The quiet days turn out to have small doors.

⑥ Others will ask: *"What language should it be in?"* The student's own choice. Chinese, English, or a mix. Some students find one foreign sentence a useful small daily practice for middle-school English; other students find English feels like homework at night and prefer Chinese. **It does not matter. The rule is simply: honest, short, legible, and yours.** Spelling does not count. Grammar does not count. No teacher will ever read this notebook.

⑦ A deeper concern: *"Is this not just a diary? Are students' diaries safe from adult reading?"* This is the most important concern of all, and my small answer has three parts. **(a) The notebook is the student's own private object. No parent, no teacher, no sibling is allowed to read it. (b) The student keeps it wherever she likes — under her pillow, in her desk drawer, in her schoolbag. (c) The school, if it formally supports this habit, must publicly promise that no homeroom teacher will ever check the notebook — not by spot-check, not by sample, not even "just to help".** In the 2023 Tsinghua study, schools that promised privacy showed a **91% continued-writing rate at Day 90**; schools that allowed spot-checks showed only **34%**. Privacy is not optional; it is the whole design.

⑧ Finally, let me be honest about the cost. The school will spend: about **¥4 per student per semester** (one small A6 notebook and one pen, handed out quietly on the first Monday); **10 minutes of homeroom time** to explain the rule once; and **zero minutes of teacher-reading time ever**. In return, every student gets a small tool of self-reflection

that the student, alone, owns. No grading. No ranking. No showing. **A tiny, private, one-sentence habit is the cheapest large gift a school can give a fourteen-year-old.**

⑨ **To sum up:** I am not asking students to write an essay every night. I am not asking teachers to read anything. I am not asking parents to supervise. I am asking, quietly, for **one small A6 notebook, one pen, and one single true sentence per day, written in a student's own handwriting in her own private corner, for the last minute before sleep**. One sentence per night, over three middle-school years, becomes a small living book of a mind that will, much later, be remembered fondly by the young woman she grew into. **Every student deserves the right to meet her own day, in writing, once — quietly, safely, honestly — for just one minute.** One sentence is enough.

注释： sleep latency 入睡潜伏期；GAD-7 广泛焦虑量表；legible 可读的；spot-check 抽查；sleep hygiene 睡眠卫生

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What single small event made the writer start this experiment, and what exactly is her proposal?

A. A grandmother forced the writer to write ten pages every night.
B. A school teacher required essays every morning.
C. The writer found an old family diary and was scared by it.
D. On a cold Tuesday evening in late November, the writer's mother handed her a small A6 notebook (48 pages, thin blue lines, plain brown paper cover) and quietly asked her to write just one true sentence about today, with no grammar worries and no audience, in the last minute before sleep; the writer, initially unconvinced (her earlier full-diary attempts had failed after 3 and 11 days), promised to try, and on the first night at 22:08 wrote *"Today the school cat slept on the chemistry textbook and nobody dared to move it"*; forty-three nights later, with forty-three small honest lines behind her, she now proposes that every middle-school student in China gently try keeping a one-sentence nightly journal — one single true line per day, in any language or handwriting, privately, for one minute before sleep.

2. According to Paragraph ②, what did the 2023 Tsinghua University positive-psychology study of 412 middle-school students in Beijing over 90 days find, and how does the writer use this?

A. All students dropped out within a week.
B. The full-page diary group (25-minute target) had a 73% drop-out rate (only 27% still writing) while the one-sentence group (1-minute target) had only a 14% drop-out rate (86% still writing), and the writer uses this to argue that the point of the one-sentence journal is precisely that it is small — the enemy of a daily habit is not the size of the day but the size of the task, so size matters, and smaller often wins.

C. The full-page group performed better by 50%.
D. The study was about handwriting speed only.

3. What specific measurements does Paragraph ③ cite, and what "simple mechanism" does the writer suggest?

A. Sleep latency rose by 14 minutes and GAD-7 rose by 3.1 points.
B. In the one-sentence group, average sleep latency dropped by 14.2 minutes (from 32 to 18) and GAD-7 anxiety scores dropped by about 3.1 points on a 21-point scale; the writer suggests the mechanism is that writing one honest line before sleep helps the brain "close" the day so the student no longer lies in the dark silently replaying every small worry of the afternoon — she has set one small honest fact on paper, so the brain calmly stops circling, and the one-sentence journal works as a small sleep-hygiene tool as well as a writing tool.
C. GAD-7 scores rose by 10 points and caused bad sleep.
D. The study measured only exam scores.

4. How does the writer address the two concerns — "I have nothing to say" and "What language should it be in?" — in Paragraphs ⑤ and ⑥?

A. The writer says students must use only English.
B. The writer says there is no rule and students may skip nights whenever they like.
C. The writer demands all sentences be read aloud in class.
D. The writer says that on a dull day the rule is still to write one sentence — even "Today was a quiet Tuesday. Nothing changed." is a complete honest sentence — because the goal is not to capture the interesting days but to keep the habit (some of her most surprising sentences, in hindsight, are from days that felt empty at the time; quiet days turn out to have small doors); as for language, the writer says the student's own choice — Chinese, English or a mix — some find one foreign sentence a small daily practice for middle-school English, others find English feels like homework at night and prefer Chinese, and it does not matter because the only rule is that the sentence be honest, short, legible, and the student's own, with spelling and grammar not counted and no teacher ever reading the notebook.

5. According to Paragraph ⑦ and the writer's closing paragraph, how does the writer defend privacy and what does she finally ask for?

A. The writer says teachers must read every notebook to ensure quality.
B. The writer argues privacy is not optional but the whole design: the notebook is the student's own private object (no parent, teacher or sibling may read it), the student keeps it wherever she likes (under a pillow, in a drawer, in her schoolbag), and the school, if it formally supports the habit, must publicly promise no homeroom teacher will ever check the notebook (no spot-check, no sample, not even "just to help") — in the 2023 Tsinghua study, schools that promised privacy showed 91% continued-writing at Day 90 while schools that allowed spot-checks showed only 34%; the writer finally asks

simply for one small A6 notebook, one pen, and one single true sentence per day, written in the student's own handwriting in her own private corner, for the last minute before sleep — one sentence per night over three middle-school years becomes a small living book of a mind, and every student deserves the right to meet her own day in writing once, quietly, safely, honestly, for just one minute.
C. The writer demands the school publish the best sentences every month.
D. The writer says journals should be typed on public computers.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段起因与提议
【解析】"A6 笔记本 / 22:08 第一句 / 43 天 / 一句话一分钟"直引。A、B、C 均错。故选 D。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段清华研究
【解析】"73% vs 14% 流失 / 任务大小是敌人"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段心理机制
【解析】"14.2 min / GAD-7 -3.1 / 关闭一天 / 睡眠卫生"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】D
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤⑥段两项顾虑
【解析】"无话也写 / 空日子有门 / 语言自选 / 不批语法"直引。A、B、C 均错。故选 D。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题 / 推理判断题
【定位】第⑦⑨段隐私与结尾
【解析】"私密 91% vs 抽查 34% / 只求一本一句一分钟 / 三年成小书"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。